

FILM DOSSIER: GUARDIANS OF THE GALAXY: COSMIC AVENGERS

Phase 3 · Film #4 (Saga Film #21)

Status:  DOSSIER COMPLETE (awaiting showrunner lock)

1. IDENTITY

Field	Entry
Film #	21 of 29 (Phase 3, Film #4)
Phase	Phase 3
Real title	<i>GUARDIANS OF THE GALAXY: COSMIC AVENGERS</i> (the title of the 616 arc)
Decoy / codename title	<i>"MIXTAPE II"</i>
Release date	Friday, May 5, 2017
Distributor	Walt Disney Studios Motion Pictures
Director	James Gunn
Rating / runtime	PG-13 · 158 minutes
Genre + second genre	Superhero action-adventure + space opera / family drama

2. OWNERSHIP

Field	Entry
Whose film / franchise is this?	The Guardians ensemble , led by Chris Pratt

Character	Actor	Age at release
Peter Quill / Star-Lord	Chris Pratt	37
Gamora	Zoe Saldña	38
Drax	Dave Bautista	48
Rocket	Bradley Cooper / Sean Gunn	42 / 42
Groot	Vin Diesel	49
Mantis	Pom Klementieff	31
Nebula	Karen Gillan	29
J'son, Emperor of Spartax	Liam Neeson (<i>fresh casting: never played by a real actor</i>)	64
Tony Stark / Iron Man	Marc-Anthony Bullock	35
Yondu Udonta (<i>the Guardians of 3000</i>)	Michael Rooker	62
Stakar / Starhawk (<i>the Guardians of 3000</i>)	Sylvester Stallone	70
Thanos / Death / Mephisto (<i>post-credit</i>)	Josh Brolin / Aubrey Plaza / Ciarán Hinds	49 / 32 / 64
Stan Lee (<i>cameo: an old man in a spacesuit chatting with the Watchers</i>)	Stan Lee	94

3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

Field	Entry
Primary comic(s) adapted	<i>Guardians of the Galaxy</i> vol. 3 #1–3 (2013), Brian Michael Bendis & Steve McNiven, "Cosmic Avengers": J'son of Spartax is Peter Quill's father, the Galactic Council declares Earth off-limits, the Badoon invade London, and Iron Man joins the Guardians.
Supporting comics	<i>Marvel Super-Heroes</i> #18 (1969): the original Guardians of the Galaxy of the year 3000, Yondu and Starhawk · <i>Guardians 3000</i> (2014) · <i>The Infinity Gauntlet</i> #1 (1991): Thanos keeps Nebula alive in torment as a trophy · <i>Avengers</i> #257 (1985, Nebula)
Nerf check	✓ The Badoon armada outnumbers them a thousand to one. They win on tactics and Iron Man's Extremis hack of the Badoon fleet, not by suddenly becoming stronger.

3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

Field	Entry
Overall accuracy score	95%. "Cosmic Avengers" is adapted with its core beats, plus a seed from the 1969 Guardians.

Straight from the page:

- **J'son**, the emperor of **Spartax**, is **Peter's father**. He left Meredith Quill on Earth (vol. 3 #0.1–1).
- **The Galactic Council** (Spartax, the Kree, the Shi'ar, the Badoon and others) **declares Earth off-limits** (#1).
- **The Badoon attack London** (#2–3). They're the race that killed Peter's mother (*Marvel Preview* #4).
- **Iron Man flies out to join the Guardians** as Earth's representative (#1).
- **The original Guardians of the Galaxy**, including **Yondu**, the blue-skinned archer, and **Starhawk**, protect the galaxy in **the year 3000** (*Marvel Super-Heroes* #18).
- **Thanos keeps Nebula alive in torment**, suspended between life and death (*Infinity Gauntlet* #1).

Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

|---|---|

| The Guardians of 3000 time-travel to the present | *Guardians 3000* (2014) did this on 616. Here it's used to warn about the snap. |

| J'son's motive is tied to Thanos (the Council is afraid Earth will draw his attention) | It connects the story to the Infinity Saga |

POWERS & ABILITIES

Character	616 powers & abilities	Shown in this film	Held back (why)	Match
The Guardians	As in the first film	Their best teamwork yet	–	✓ 100%
Iron Man (Extremis)	Extremis; a space-rated armor (616: his Bendis-era space armor)	Hacks the Badoon command ship through Extremis; fights in orbit	–	✓ 100%
J'son	Emperor; master strategist; Spartax technology	Commands a fleet; duels Peter	–	✓ 100%
Yondu	Master archer with the Yaka arrow (whistle-controlled), a Centaurian	The arrow in action	–	✓ 100%
Starhawk	Cosmic light-manipulation; flight; precognition ("the one who knows")	He knows about the snap before it happens	–	✓ 100%
Nebula	Cybernetic warrior; pirate	Fights Gamora, then fights beside her	–	✓ 100%

4. STORY

Field	Entry
Logline	When the galaxy's rulers declare Earth off-limits, Star-Lord finds out the man behind it is his father, and has to choose between the empire he was born to and the planet his mother died on.
Theme	Fathers. Peter and J'son. Gamora and Nebula and Thanos. Every Guardian has to choose who they belong to.
Villain / antagonist	J'son (main); the Badoon ; Nebula (at first)

What the movie is about

ACT ONE: OFF-LIMITS

- **Earth date: Monday, February 13, 2017.** The **Galactic Council** meets and **declares Earth off-limits** to every race.
- **Peter Quill** is summoned to the Council and meets its president, **J'son, emperor of Spartax**. J'son is **his father**.
- The Guardians **refuse to stay away from Earth**.

ACT TWO: LONDON

- The **Badoon**, the race that killed Peter's mother, **invade London** in defiance of the Council.
- **Iron Man**, now Director of S.H.I.E.L.D., flies into orbit to meet the Guardians. Rocket: *"So he's real."*
- **Nebula** is with the Badoon, hired to kill Gamora. The sisters fight across the Thames, and then **stand together** when the Badoon betray Nebula.
- Peter finds out that **J'son brought the Badoon here** to scare the Council into stripping Earth's protections.

ACT THREE: GUARDIANS OF 3000

- The battle over London. Iron Man hacks the Badoon command ship through Extremis, and the Guardians bring it down.
 - Peter faces J'son: *"You're not my father. My father is a guy named Yondu who stole me when I was a kid."* J'son loses the Council's support.
 - A **time-rift** opens. Out of it come **Yondu** and **Starhawk, the Guardians of the Galaxy from the year 3000**.
 - **Starhawk:** *"We came back to warn you. In our time, half the stars are dead. Half of everything is gone. It starts soon."*
 - The rift closes, and they're gone. The Guardians look at each other. So does Iron Man.
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5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

Field	Entry
When it's set	Earth dates Monday, February 13, 2017 → Saturday, April 15, 2017 .
Where it's set	Spartax · the Galactic Council's station · London (filmed on location) · Earth orbit
Relative to other films	Six months after <i>Doctor Strange</i> . Tony tells the Guardians that "a sorcerer in the Village" says the end of the world is coming, and Rocket laughs until Mantis confirms it.

6. WORLD-BUILDING

The film's own world

- **Spartax**, **J'son**, the **Galactic Council**, the **Badoon**.
- **The Guardians of 3000**, and the future after the snap.
- **Gamora and Nebula**: the sisters start healing.

World-building for the wider MCU

Seed	How it appears	Payoff
Iron Man meets the Guardians	The first cosmic alliance	<i>The Infinity Gauntlet</i>
The Galactic Council	The cosmos's politics	<i>The Infinity Gauntlet</i>
The future	The Guardians of 3000	<i>The Infinity Gauntlet</i>

Setting up the Big Bad

Seed	How it appears	What it means
"Half of everything is gone"	Starhawk's warning	The snap is confirmed
Nebula taken	The post-credit scene	<i>The Infinity Gauntlet</i> #1, straight from the page

7. POST-CREDIT SCENES

Field	Entry
Mid-credit scene	✓ "GROWING." Groot is now a moody adolescent sapling who ignores everyone and plays video games. Peter: " <i>Groot, clean your room.</i> " Groot: " <i>I am Groot.</i> " Rocket: " <i>Language!</i> "
Post-credit scene	✓ "TROPHY." Thanos's throne room. Nebula , captured on her way home, is suspended in agony in a field of energy, neither dead nor alive . Thanos looks at her like an ornament. MEPHISTO : " <i>A gift for your lady?</i> " THANOS : " <i>A reminder of what I don't need.</i> " He turns to Death and holds up the Gauntlet: " <i>I've decided, my love. Half of everything. For you.</i> " For the first time, Death looks at him . CUT TO BLACK. " THE GUARDIANS OF THE GALAXY WILL RETURN. "
Secret shoot codenames	Mid-credit: " TEEN SPIRIT. " Post-credit: " MUSEUM PIECE. "

CHECKLIST

- [x] Comic(s) adapted · [x] Comic Accuracy Report + powers · [x] Real and decoy titles · [x] What it's about · [x] Villain · [x] Post-credit scenes · [x] The film's own world-building · [x] MCU world-building · [x] Big Bad setup · [x] Whose franchise · [x] When and where in the timeline